

Coimisiún na Scrúduithe Stáit
State Examinations Commission

Leaving Certificate Examination 2023

Ancient Greek

Higher Level

Monday 19 June Morning 9:30 – 12:30

400 marks

The 2023 examination papers were adjusted to compensate for disruptions to learning due to COVID-19. This examination paper does not necessarily reflect the same structure and format as the examination papers of past or subsequent years.

1. Answer Section A **or** Section B. **[50]**

A. Translate into Greek.

The philosopher was a poor man and he always had his door unlocked. One night, he saw a thief enter the house to find something valuable. The thief thought that the philosopher was sleeping, for he was motionless. At last, having found nothing, the thief swore at the philosopher, but quietly; for he did not want to wake him. Hearing this, the philosopher said, "My friend, if I can't find something valuable here during the day, how can you hope to find it by night?"

poor man: πένης, πένητος, ὁ. unlocked: ἄκλῃστος, -ον. thief: κλέπτης, -ου, ὁ.
valuable: πολυτελής, -ές. motionless: ἀκίνητος, -ον. I swear at: κακῶς λέγω.
quietly: ἥσυχως I wake: ἐγείρω.

OR

B. Read the following passage and answer, in English, **all** the questions which follow.

(Cyrus the Great's army is winning a battle against many enemies.
Only the Egyptians remain and fight against him.)

καὶ ἔδοξε τῷ Κύρῳ ἀναβῆναι ἐπὶ πύργον τινὰ καὶ κατασκέψασθαι εἴ πῃ μένοιεν οἱ πολέμιοι καὶ μάχοιντο. ἐπεὶ δὲ ἀνέβη, κατεῖδε τὸ πεδίον μεστὸν ἵππων, ἀνθρώπων, ἁρμάτων, φευγόντων, διωκόντων, κρατούντων, κρατουμένων· οὐδαμοῦ δ' ἔτι ἐδύνατο κατιδεῖν τοὺς πολεμίους μένοντας πλὴν τοὺς Αἰγυπτίους· οὗτοι δὲ ἐπειδὴ ἠποροῦντο, πάντοθεν κύκλον ποιησάμενοι, ἐποίουν μὲν οὐδὲν ἔτι, ἔπασχον δὲ πολλὰ καὶ δεινά.

ὁ δὲ Κῦρος, ἀγασθεὶς αὐτοὺς καὶ οἰκτείρων ὅτι ἀγαθοὶ ἄνδρες ὄντες ἀπώλλυντο, πέμπει πρὸς αὐτοὺς κήρυκα ἐρωτῶν πότερα πάντες ἀπολέσθαι βούλονται ὑπὲρ τῶν προδεδωκότων αὐτοὺς ἢ σωθῆναι ἄνδρες ἀγαθοὶ δοκοῦντες εἶναι.

οἱ δ' ἀπεκρίναντο, "πῶς δ' ἂν ἡμεῖς σωθείημεν ἄνδρες ἀγαθοὶ δοκοῦντες εἶναι;"

ὁ δὲ Κῦρος ἔλεγεν, "ἡμεῖς ὑμᾶς ὁρῶμεν μόνους καὶ μένοντας καὶ μάχεσθαι ἐθέλοντας."

Κῦρος, -ου, ὁ: Cyrus. πύργος, -ου, ὁ: tower. κατασκοπέω: I investigate.
πῃ: anywhere. μεστός (+ Genitive Case): full of. κρατέω: I defeat.
πλήν: except. Αἰγυπτίος, -ου, ὁ: Egyptian.
ἀπορέομαι: I am in a desperate situation. ἄγαμαι: I admire. οἰκτείρω: I pity.
προδίδωμι: I betray.

(a) What did Cyrus decide to do? (6)

(b) What did he want to investigate? (6)

(c) What did Cyrus see in the plain and what were they doing? (8)

(d) What did the Egyptians do in their desperate situation? (4)

(e) Did this strategy of the Egyptians make any impact? Explain your answer. (5)

(f) Why did Cyrus pity the Egyptians? (6)

(g) What **two** things did the herald ask on behalf of Cyrus? (9)

(h) What does Cyrus say in response to the Egyptians? (6)

2. Translate into English **one** passage from Section A and **one** passage from Section B. **[180]**

A.

(i) *(The Greek army is on the march through difficult weather and terrain, with Cheirisophus in the lead and Xenophon in charge of the rearguard. Coming under attack, they lose two men.)*

ἔπειτα δὲ γίγνεται χειμὼν πολύς, ἀναγκαῖον δ’ ἦν πορεύεσθαι· οὐ γὰρ ἦν ἱκανὰ τὰ ἐπιτήδεια. καὶ ἡγεῖτο μὲν Χειρίσοφος, ὠπισθοφυλάκει δὲ Ξενοφῶν. καὶ οἱ πολέμιοι ἰσχυρῶς ἐπετίθεντο, καὶ στενῶν ὄντων τῶν χωρίων ἐγγὺς προσιόντες ἐτόξευον· ὥστε οἱ Ἕλληνες ἐπιδιώκοντες καὶ πάλιν ἀναχάζοντες βραδέως πορεύεσθαι ἠναγκάζοντο·

καὶ πολλάκις παρήγγελλεν ὁ Ξενοφῶν ὑπομένειν, ἀλλ’ ὁ Χειρίσοφος ἦγε ταχέως καὶ παρηγγύα ἔπεσθαι, ὥστε δῆλον ἦν ὅτι πρᾶγμά τι εἴη· σχολὴ δ’ οὐκ ἦν τῷ Ξενοφῶντι παρελθόντι ἰδεῖν τὸ αἴτιον τῆς σπουδῆς· ὥστε ἡ πορεία ὁμοία φυγῇ ἐγίγνετο τοῖς ὀπισθοφύλαξι.

καὶ ἐνταῦθα ἀποθνῄσκει ἀνὴρ ἀγαθὸς Λακωνικὸς Κλεώνυμος τοξευθεὶς διὰ τῆς ἀσπίδος εἰς τὰς πλευράς, καὶ Βασίας Ἀρκὰς διαμπερὲς τὴν κεφαλήν.

XENOPHON (90)

Χειρίσοφος, -ου, ὁ: Cheirisophus.
Ξενοφῶν, -ῶντος, ὁ: Xenophon.
στενός, -ή, -όν: narrow.
ἀναχάζω: I fall back.
πρᾶγμα, -ατος, τό: (the) matter, trouble.
σπουδή, -ῆς, ἡ: haste.
ὀπισθοφύλακες, -ων, οἱ: the rearguard.
Κλεώνυμος, -ου, ὁ: Cleonymus.
Βασίας, -ου, ὁ: Basias.
διαμπερές (+ Accusative Case): through.
ὀπισθοφυλακέω: I guard the rear.
ἐπιτίθεμαι: I attack.
τοξεύω: I shoot (with arrows).
παρεγγυάω: I pass along the order.
σχολή, -ῆς, ἡ: opportunity, spare-time.
πορεία, -ας, ἡ: march, journey.
Λακωνικός, -ή, -όν: Spartan.
πλευρά, -ᾶς, ἡ: rib, side.
Ἀρκάς, -άδος, ὁ: Arcadian.

OR

(ii) *(Opposite the town of Oeniadae lie the Echinades islands, formed from silt deposited into the sea by the Achelous river. Alcmaeon son of Amphiaraus settled in this region, after following the god Apollo's instructions about how to cleanse himself after committing murder.)*

κεῖνται δὲ αἱ πολλαὶ τῶν νήσων τῶν Ἐχινάδων καταντικρὺ Οἰνιαδῶν, οὐδὲν ἀπέχουσαι τῶν ἐκβολῶν τοῦ Ἀχελώου, ὥστε μέγας ὢν ὁ ποταμὸς προσχοῖ αἰεὶ καὶ εἰσί τινες τῶν νήσων αἳ ἠπείρωνται. ἐρῆμοι δ' εἰσὶ αἱ νῆσοι καὶ οὐ μεγάλαι.

μετὰ τὸν τῆς μητρὸς φόνον λέγεται δὲ τὸν Ἀπόλλω χρῆσαι Ἀλκμαίωνι τῷ Ἀμφιαράου ταύτην τὴν γῆν οἰκεῖν, εἰπόντα οὐκ εἶναι λύσιν τῶν φόβων πρὶν ἂν ἐν ταύτῃ τῇ χώρᾳ κατοικίσηται ἥτις ὅτε τὴν μητέρα ἔκτεινε μηδὲ ὑπὸ ἡλίου ἑωρᾶτο μηδὲ γῇ ἦν, ὡς τῆς γε ἄλλης γῆς αὐτῷ μεμιασμένης. ὁ δ' ἀπορῶν, ὥς φασι, κατενόησε τὴν πρόσχωσιν ταύτην τοῦ Ἀχελώου, καὶ ἐδόκει αὐτῷ ἱκανὴ γῆ ἂν προσχεῶσθαι ἀφ' οὗπερ τὴν μητέρα ἔκτεινε.

THUCYDIDES (90)

Ἐχινάδες, -ων, αἱ: Echinades.
Οἰνιάδαι, -ῶν, αἱ: Oeniadae.
ἐκβολή, -ῆς, ἡ: outlet, mouth (of a river).
προσχόω: I deposit silt, I silt up.
ἐρῆμος, -ον: deserted.
χράω: I give direction, I prophesise.
Ἀμφιάραος, -ου, ὁ: Amphiaraus.
κατοικίζομαι: I settle.
μιαίνω: I pollute.
πρόσχωσις, -εως, ἡ: sand-bar, deposit.
καταντικρύ (+ Genitive Case): opposite.
ἀπέχω (+ Genitive Case): I am far from.
Ἀχελῷος, -ου, ὁ: Achelous river.
ἠπειρόω: I make part of the mainland.
Ἀπόλλων, -ωνος, ὁ: Apollo.
Ἀλκμαίων, -ωνος, ὁ: Alcmaeon.
λύσις, -εως, ἡ: release.
ἑωρᾶτο = "was seen".
κατανοέω: I see.
ἀφ' οὗπερ: from the time that.

B.

(i) (*Neoptolemus, son of Achilles, speaks about his arrival at Troy after his father's death. Welcomed by the army, he was denied his father's arms by the sons of Atreus, as they had already been awarded to Odysseus.)*

κἀγὼ πικρὸν Σίγειον οὐρίῳ πλάτῃ
κατηγόμην· καί μ' εὐθὺς ἐν κύκλῳ στρατὸς
ἐκβάντα πᾶς ἠσπάζετ', ὀμνύντες βλέπειν
τὸν οὐκέτ' ὄντα ζῶντ' Ἀχιλλέα πάλιν.
κεῖνος μὲν οὖν ἔκειτ'· ἐγὼ δ' ὁ δύσμορος,
ἐπεὶ 'δάκρυσα κεῖνον, οὐ μακρῷ χρόνῳ
ἐλθὼν Ἀτρείδας προσφιλῶς, ὡς εἰκὸς ἦν,
τά θ' ὅπλ' ἀπήτουν τοῦ πατρὸς τά τ' ἄλλ' ὅσ' ἦν.
οἱ δ' εἶπον, οἴμοι, τλημονέστατον λόγον,
"ὦ σπέρμ' Ἀχιλλέως, τἄλλα μὲν πάρεστί σοι
πατρῷ' ἐλέσθαι, τῶν δ' ὅπλων κείνων ἀνὴρ
ἄλλος κρατύνει νῦν, ὁ Λαέρτου γόνος."

SOPHOCLES (90)

κἀγώ = καὶ ἐγώ
Σίγειον, -ου, τό: Sigeum (a city near Troy).
πλάτη, -ης, ἡ: oar, voyage.
ὄμνυμι: I swear.
κεῖμαι: I lay (unburied).
Ἀτρείδης, -ου, ὁ: son of Atreus.
τλήμων, -ον: miserable.
τἄλλα = τά ἄλλα
Λαέρτης, -ου, ὁ: Laertes.
πικρός, -ά, -όν: hateful.
οὔριος, -ον: favourable.
ἀσπάζομαι: I greet.
Ἀχιλλεύς, -έως, ὁ: Achilles.
δύσμορος, -ον: ill-fated.
εἰκώς, -υῖα, -ός: reasonable.
σπέρμα, -ατος, τό: son, seed.
κρατύνω (+ Genitive Case): I take hold of.
γόνος, -ου, ὁ: son.

OR

(ii) *(Zeus orders the gods and goddesses not to help the Trojans or the Greeks in the Trojan War. Zeus warns that if any of them try to disobey, he will punish them.)*

"κέκλυτέ μευ πάντες τε θεοὶ πᾶσαί τε θέαιναι,
ὄφρ' εἴπω τά με θυμὸς ἐνὶ στήθεσσι κελεύει.
μήτέ τις οὖν θήλεια θεὸς τό γε μήτέ τις ἄρσην
πειράτω διακέρσαι ἐμὸν ἔπος, ἀλλ' ἅμα πάντες
αἰνεῖτ', ὄφρα τάχιστα τελευτήσω τάδε ἔργα.
ὃν δ' ἂν ἐγὼν ἀπάνευθε θεῶν ἐθέλοντα νοήσω
ἐλθόντ' ἢ Τρώεσσιν ἀρηγέμεν ἢ Δαναοῖσι
πληγεὶς οὐ κατὰ κόσμον, ἐλεύσεται Οὔλυμπονδέ·
ἤ μιν ἐλὼν ῥίψω ἐς Τάρταρον ἠερόεντα
τῆλε μάλ', ἧχι βάθιστον ὑπὸ χθονός ἐστι βέρεθρον."

HOMER (90)

κλύω: I listen, I obey (+ Genitive Case).
θῆλυς, -εια, -υ: female.
πειράω: I attempt, I try.
αἰνέω: I agree.
νοέω: I notice, I observe.
ἀρήγω: I help.
πλήσσω: I strike down.
Οὔλυμπος, -οιο, ὁ: Olympus.
ἠερόεις, -εσσα, -εν: murky.
ἧχι: where.
στῆθος, -εος, τό: chest.
ἄρσην, -εν: male.
διακείρω: I disregard, I disobey.
ἀπάνευθε (+ Genitive Case): against.
Τρῶες, -ων, οἱ: Trojans.
Δαναοί, -ῶν, οἱ: Greeks.
ἐλεύσεται = Future Tense of ἔρχομαι.
Τάρταρος, -ου, ὁ: Tartarus.
τῆλε: far.
βέρεθρον, -ου, τό: pit.

3. Answer **either** Section A **or** Section B. **[80]**

A.

(i) Translate into English. (50)

ὥστε βουλόμενοι αὐτὸν ἐς κρίσιν ἀγαγόντες ἀποκτεῖναι, πέμπουσιν οὕτω τὴν Σαλαμινίαν ναῦν ἐς τὴν Σικελίαν ἐπί τε ἐκεῖνον καὶ ὧν πέρι ἄλλων ἐμεμήνυτο. εἴρητο δὲ προειπεῖν αὐτῷ ἀπολογησομένῳ ἀκολουθεῖν, ξυλλαμβάνειν δὲ μή, θεραπεύοντες τό τε πρὸς τοὺς ἐν τῇ Σικελίᾳ στρατιώτας τε σφετέρους καὶ πολεμίους μὴ θορυβεῖν καὶ οὐχ ἥκιστα τοὺς Μαντινέας καὶ Ἀργείους βουλόμενοι παραμεῖναι, δι' ἐκείνου νομίζοντες πεισθῆναι σφίσι ξυστρατεύειν.

καὶ ὁ μὲν ἔχων τὴν ἑαυτοῦ ναῦν καὶ οἱ ξυνδιαβεβλημένοι ἀπέπλεον μετὰ τῆς Σαλαμινίας ἐκ τῆς Σικελίας ὡς ἐς τὰς Ἀθήνας· καὶ ἐπειδὴ ἐγένοντο ἐν Θουρίοις, οὐκέτι ξυνείποντο, ἀλλ' ἀπελθόντες ἀπὸ τῆς νεὼς οὐ φανεροὶ ἦσαν, δείσαντες τὸ ἐπὶ διαβολῇ ἐς δίκην καταπλεῦσαι.

THE INTELLECTUAL REVOLUTION

(ii) Answer **any three** of the following questions. They carry ten marks each. (30)

(a) Explain why Alkibiades was recalled to Athens from the Sicilian Expedition.

(b) Comment on what you have learned from Thucydides about the character of Nikias.

(c) Outline the course of the battle in the Syracusan harbour.

(d) Describe the scene and the mood of the Athenians when the expedition departs for Sicily.

(e) Why did the Athenians decide to set out on the Sicilian Expedition?

(f) Write a brief note on **any two** of the following:

the *Salaminia*; Demosthenes; Lamachus; Egesta.

(g) Identify **and** explain the case of ὧν **and** the voice of πεισθῆναι underlined in the passage above.

OR

B.

(i) Translate into English. (50)

ΤΕ. λέγω δέ σοι· τὸν ἄνδρα τοῦτον, ὃν πάλαι
ζητεῖς ἀπειλῶν κἀνακηρύσσων φόνον
τὸν Λαΐειον, οὗτός ἐστιν ἐνθάδε.
ξένος λόγῳ μέτοικος, εἶτα δ' ἐγγενὴς
φανήσεται Θηβαῖος, οὐδ' ἡσθήσεται
τῇ ξυμφορᾷ· τυφλὸς γὰρ ἐκ δεδορκότος
καὶ πτωχὸς ἀντὶ πλουσίου ξένην ἔπι
σκήπτρῳ προδεικνὺς γαῖαν ἐμπορεύσεται.
φανήσεται δὲ παισὶ τοῖς αὐτοῦ ξυνὼν
ἀδελφὸς αὐτὸς καὶ πατήρ, κἀξ ἧς ἔφυ
γυναικὸς υἱὸς καὶ πόσις, καὶ τοῦ πατρὸς
ὁμόσπορός τε καὶ φονεύς. καὶ ταῦτ' ἰὼν
εἴσω λογίζου· κἂν λάβῃς ἐψευσμένον,
φάσκειν ἔμ' ἤδη μαντικῇ μηδὲν φρονεῖν.

A WORLD OF HEROES

(ii) Answer **any three** of the following questions. They carry ten marks each. (30)

(a) How does Oedipus react to the news that Teiresias delivers in the above speech?

(b) Outline the role played by Teiresias in the course of the play.

(c) Examine how Sophocles uses dramatic irony throughout this play.
Include at least **one** example in your answer.

(d) Comment on the importance of the Delphic oracle in this play.

(e) What do you think is **one** of Oedipus' flaws? Explain your answer.

(f) Write a short note on **any two** of the following:

the messenger; Iokaste; the Chorus; Kreon.

(g) Scan the **first line** in the passage above. Mark the quantities **and** name the metre.

4. Answer **any three** of the following questions. Each question carries thirty marks. **[90]**

(i) Give a summary of **either** the battles of Pylos and Sphacteria (425 BC) **or** the battle of Amphipolis (422 BC). In your answer, explain the significance of the battle you chose.

(ii) Write notes on **any two** of the following:

March of the 10,000; Tissaphernes; rule of The Thirty; Pericles; Epaminondas.

(iii) Outline the achievements of Alexander the Great during his conquest of the Persian Empire. In your answer, explain what you consider to be his greatest achievement.

(iv) Compare the main features of the Athenian and Spartan governments.
Explain which system you prefer and why.

(v) Write a biographical note on Thucydides **and** assess his strengths and weaknesses as an historian.

(vi) Outline the life and works of Sophocles **and** assess his importance as a dramatist.

(vii) Give a description of the architectural features of **one** temple on the Acropolis and explain the temple's significance. You may use a diagram to support your answer.

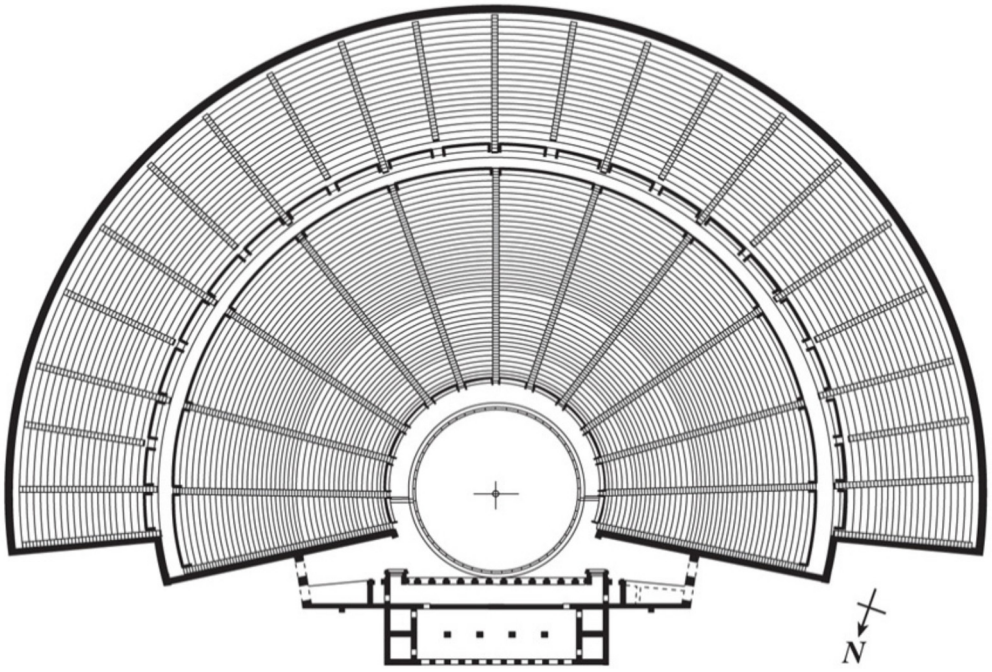
(viii) Look at Photographs **A**, **B** and **C** below and answer **any two** of the following questions:

(a) What type of building is shown in Photograph **A?** State the main features of this type of building and give a brief description of their functions.

(b) Is the vase in Photograph **B** Red Figure or Black Figure?
Evaluate how the scene on this vase has been depicted.

(c) To what period does the statue in Photograph **C** belong? In your opinion, is this a good example of sculpture from this period? Explain your answer.

A



B



C



Acknowledgements

Images

Page 9: A - https://www.whitman.edu/epidaurus/epidaurus.htm

Page 10: B - https://www.penn.museum/collections/object_images.php?irn=244259.

Page 11: C - https://www.namuseum.gr/en/collection/klasiki-periodos-3/

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Leaving Certificate – Higher Level

Ancient Greek

Monday 19 June
Morning 9:30 – 12:30